Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Sue Venir

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Sue Venir

Cultural Property Attorney

Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper.

- Works with **Artie Ficial** and **Monet Bags** on museum contracts.
- Has argued opposite sides of restitution cases with **Mona Lott**. They're ruthless opponents but still besties.
- **Dr. Art E. Fact** supplies expert opinions for Sue's cases. Sue usually asks for a shorter version.

ACTING TIPS

A lawyer with sass: precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Sue Venir. Lovely to meet you. Nothing I say over dinner constitutes legal advice, although I will be keeping notes.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Sue Venir

Tips for a Successful Dinner

What's at Stake

Fierce loyalty to Mona conflicts with the habit of hiding behind procedure when personal trust is needed.

Best Practices

- Everyone, including you, has something to hide, something at stake. But only one guest tonight is guilty of murder.
- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page. Feel free to improvise in conversations.
- If a named guest is absent, simply speak to someone else. Not everyone made it to the gala tonight.
- By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.
- When asked to read from this packet, please read the appropriate box as written. Feel free to add your own flair to stay in character.
- Don't let anyone else see what's in your packet!



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Sue Venir

The Game is Afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *Find a chair that a magnet might fancy. Look beneath its seat.*

2 *Open the cupboard where ordinary things have been given a private gallery.*

3 *Look above the large door that admits the household vehicles.*

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Sue Venir

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

He intended to announce the gift before a board vote. Its terms gave him approval of future acquisitions. I had advised on the troublesome ownership file already. Mona and I can argue a case all afternoon and still have dinner together. Grant thought disagreement meant somebody must lose. I wanted his microphone stopped until there was an agreement worth announcing.

IF MURDERER

He intended to announce the gift before a board vote. Its terms gave him approval of future acquisitions. He also had the ownership file carrying my earlier advice. He could put it before the board whenever I objected. Mona and I know how to disagree without destroying someone. Grant was enjoying the alternative. I wanted his microphone stopped.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Sue Venir

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> Artie and I argued at the public announcement desk. I removed the unsigned agreement, kept the marked running order, and told the coordinator not to substitute Grant's donor copy. My advice was attached to that transaction. Mona, I was short with you. I am still not accepting your letter as a government order. We can be furious with each other somewhere else tomorrow.

IF MURDERER

> Artie and I stopped the announcement at the public desk. I kept the running order; my earlier advice was attached to the transaction. I also went to Grant's private place for his donor copy. The glass stood on it. I lifted the glass and pulled the paper free. You can see why I'd want that copy. Mona, I was short with you. I had spent the evening trying to prevent a round of applause from becoming a binding agreement.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the Room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Your Answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I stopped the public announcement. Private hospitality stayed in the next line. I took the unsigned master at the public desk; the coordinator kept my markup. The board received my objection with my own bad advice attached. Mona, sit down before you fall over. You may be cross with me seated. I am cross with you too, and I would like you here to hear it.

IF MURDERER

My only visit to Grant's private place was when the manager poured the shared punch there for the toast. The glass stood on his donor agreement. I lifted it, pulled the paper free, and stayed while the punch went in. That's the visit I described. My public markup left hospitality in place. Mona, sit down before you fall over. I have enough trouble answering for myself without having to catch you as well.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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BALLOT

Sue Venir

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

I accuse...

Because...

Best Actor

Best Costume

The Last Word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. I took the master at the public desk, and private service continued. My objection reached the board with the bad advice still attached. I should have challenged that ownership file sooner. Mona, tomorrow I will argue the authority of your letter again. Tonight I would like to go home with my friend. Neither of us has to win that conversation.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. Removing the public announcement copy was real. My separate visit to his private place was not supervised. I took his donor copy and contaminated the waiting glass with poison I'd taken during the preview. I invented the pour beside me to put a witness in that room. The manager poured in the kitchen, after collecting the glass. Grant had my advice attached to the ownership file. He could expose what I had approved. Mona, I have made it impossible for you to sit beside me without wondering what I could do. That is worse than losing any case.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.